HONG KONG EXAMINATIONS AND ASSESSMENT AUTHORITY

HONG KONG DIPLOMA OF SECONDARY EDUCATION EXAMINATION 2025

PHYSICS PAPER 1

8:30 am – 11:00 am (2½ hours)

This paper must be answered in English

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

(1) There are **TWO** sections, A and B, in this Paper. You are advised to finish Section A in about 50 minutes.

(2) Section A consists of multiple-choice questions in this question paper, while Section B contains conventional questions printed separately in Question-Answer Book **B**.

(3) Answers to Section A should be marked on the Multiple-choice Answer Sheet while answers to Section B should be written in the spaces provided in the Question-Answer Book. **The Answer Sheet for Section A and the Question-Answer Book for Section B will be collected separately at the end of the examination.**

(4) The diagrams in this paper are **NOT** necessarily drawn to scale.

(5) The last two pages of this question paper contain a list of data, formulae and relationships which you may find useful.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR SECTION A (MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS)

(1) Read carefully the instructions on the Answer Sheet. After the announcement of the start of the examination, you should first stick a barcode label and insert the information required in the spaces provided. No extra time will be given for sticking on the barcode label after the 'Time is up' announcement.

(2) When told to open this book, you should check that all the questions are there. Look for the words **'END OF SECTION A'** after the last question.

(3) All questions carry equal marks.

(4) **ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS.** You are advised to use an HB pencil to mark all the answers on the Answer Sheet, so that wrong marks can be completely erased with a rubber. You must mark the answers clearly; otherwise you will lose marks if the answers cannot be captured.

(5) You should mark only **ONE** answer for each question. If you mark more than one answer, you will receive **NO MARKS** for that question.

(6) No marks will be deducted for wrong answers.

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Not to be taken away before the end of the examination session

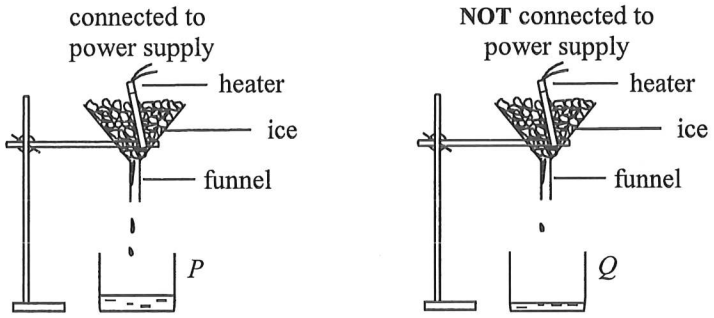
Section A

There are 33 questions. Questions marked with * involve knowledge of the extension component. Take $g = 9.81$ m s^{-2}.

1. An equal amount of energy is supplied to each of the substances P, Q, R and S of mass and specific heat capacity listed below. Which substance would have the largest rise in temperature ?

	substance	mass / kg	specific heat capacity / J kg^{-1} °C^{-1}
A.	P	2	4200
B.	Q	3	2100
C.	R	4	900
D.	S	5	840

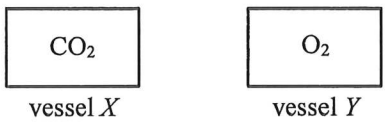
2. The set-up below can be used to find the specific latent heat of fusion of ice, l_f. The energy supplied by the heater is measured by a joulemeter. The mass of ice melted by the heater is given by the difference between the mass of water collected in beakers P and Q.



How would the calculated value of l_f be affected if
(I) the heater is not completely covered by the ice ?
(II) the mass of water collected in beaker P is taken as the mass of ice melted by the heater ?

	(I)	(II)
A.	decrease	increase
B.	decrease	decrease
C.	increase	increase
D.	increase	decrease

*3. Identical closed vessels X and Y contain carbon dioxide (CO_2) and oxygen (O_2) respectively.

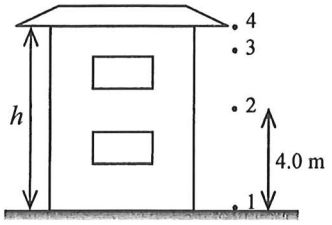


Both gases are at room temperature and atmospheric pressure. Which of the following physical quantities of the gas molecules in the two vessels is/are the same ?

(1) root-mean-square speed
(2) average kinetic energy
(3) frequency of collision with the walls of the vessel

A. (1) only
B. (2) only
C. (1) and (3) only
D. (2) and (3) only

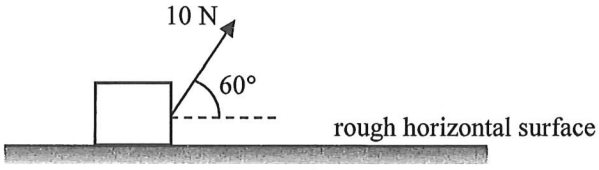
4.



Water drips regularly at a constant rate from a building's roof, which is at a height h above the ground. The droplets fall from rest such that the first droplet reaches the ground just when the fourth droplet leaves the roof as shown. If the second droplet is 4.0 m above the ground at this instant, find h. Neglect air resistance.

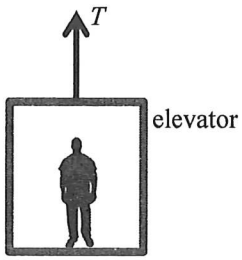
A. 5.8 m
B. 6.4 m
C. 7.2 m
D. 7.8 m

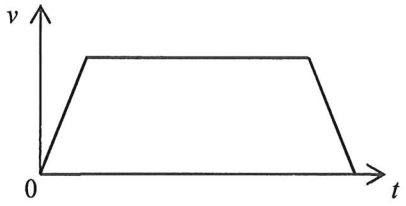
5. A block, initially at rest, is pulled along a horizontal surface by a force of 10 N making an angle of 60° with the horizontal. There is a constant friction of 2 N between the block and the horizontal surface. What is the gain in kinetic energy of the block after moving 5 m ?



A. 33 J
B. 25 J
C. 15 J
D. 10 J

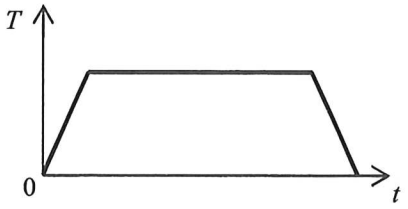
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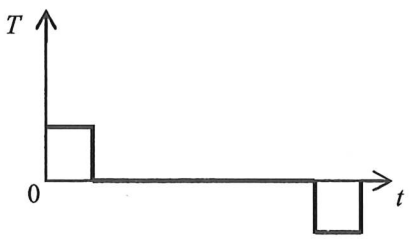


An elevator is pulled upward by a cable. The v-t graph above shows the variation of the elevator's velocity with time. Which of the following correctly indicates the variation of the tension T in the cable with time t ?

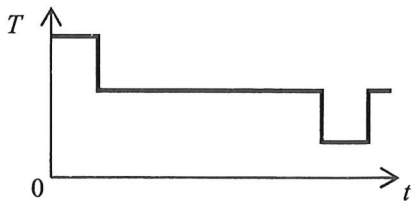
A.



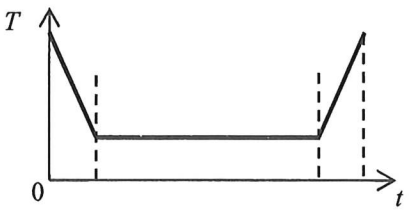
B.



C.



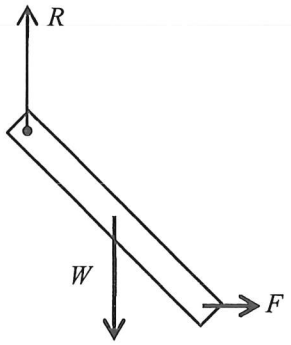
D.



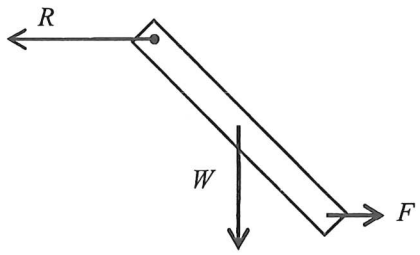
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7. A uniform rod of weight W hinged at its upper end is at rest under a horizontal force F applied at its lower end. Which figure correctly shows the force R acting on the rod at the hinge ?

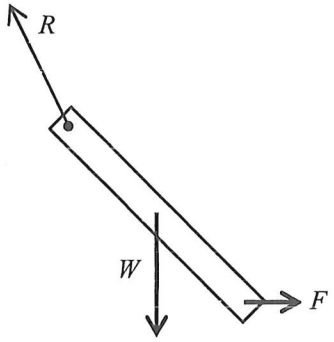
A.



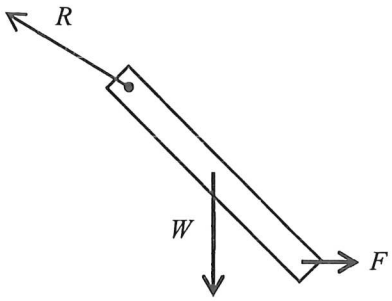
B.



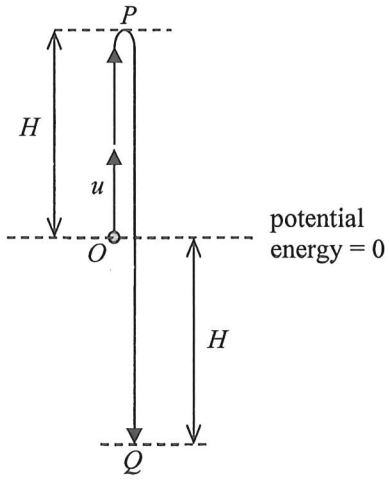
C.



D.



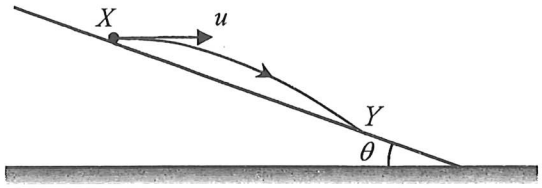
8. A small ball of mass m is thrown vertically upward from point O with an initial speed u. It reaches the highest point P and then falls to point Q such that $OP = OQ = H$. The ball's potential energy at point O is taken to be zero.



What are the kinetic energy and potential energy of the ball at point Q ? Neglect air resistance.

	kinetic energy	**potential energy**
A.	mu^2	$-mgH$
B.	mu^2	mgH
C.	$\frac{1}{2}mu^2$	$-mgH$
D.	$\frac{1}{2}mu^2$	mgH

*9.



X and Y are two points on an incline making an angle θ with the horizontal. A particle projected horizontally from X with speed u lands at Y as shown. Which expression correctly gives its time of flight from X to Y? Neglect air resistance.

A. $\dfrac{u \sin \theta}{2g}$

B. $\dfrac{u \tan \theta}{2g}$

C. $\dfrac{2u \sin \theta}{g}$

D. $\dfrac{2u \tan \theta}{g}$

10. Loosening a screw requires a pair of forces of 10 N acting tangentially as shown in Figure (1). A suitable screwdriver with a handle of diameter 0.025 m shown in Figure (2) is chosen. Estimate the magnitude of the pair of forces needed to act tangentially on the handle of the screwdriver.

Figure (1)

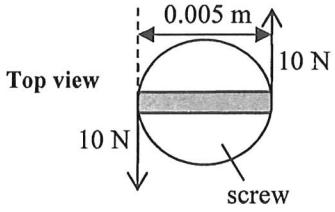


Figure (2)

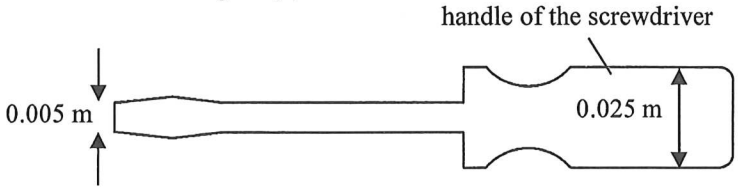
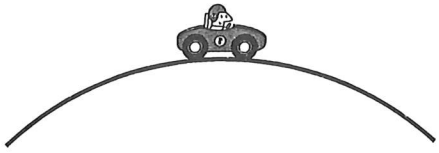


Diagram **NOT** drawn to scale

A. 2 N
B. 4 N
C. 5 N
D. 10 N

*11. A car of weight W travels with constant speed on a circular humpback bridge. At the moment when the car passes the top of the bridge, the normal reaction acting on it by the bridge is R. What is the centripetal force acting on the car at that moment?

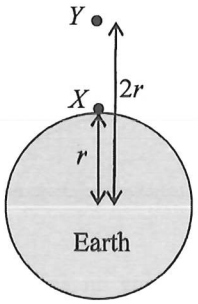


Side view

A. $W + R$
B. $W - R$
C. W
D. R

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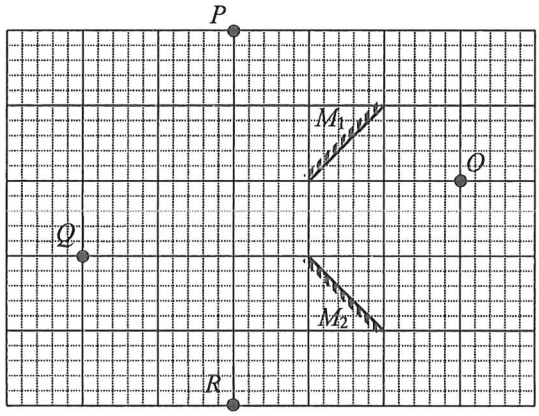
*12.



Two identical objects located at point X and point Y are at distances r and $2r$ from the Earth's centre. The weight of the object at point X is W. What is the weight of the object at point Y ?

A. $0.25W$
B. $0.5W$
C. $0.75W$
D. W

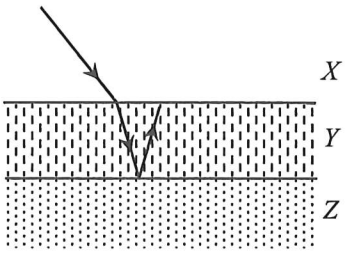
13. A point object O is placed in front of two plane mirrors M_1 and M_2 as shown.



At which position(s) can an image be formed ?

A. P, Q and R
B. Q and R only
C. R only
D. P only

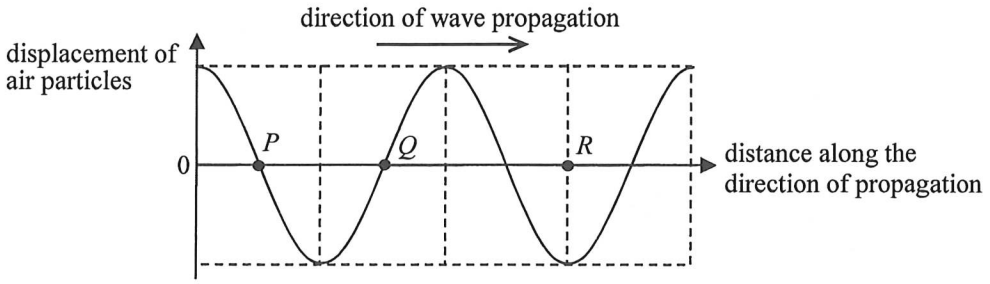
14.



The figure shows three media X, Y and Z separated by parallel boundaries. A light ray travelling from X into Y then undergoes total internal reflection at the boundary between Y and Z. Arrange in descending order the speed of light in the respective media.

A. $X\ Y\ Z$
B. $X\ Z\ Y$
C. $Y\ Z\ X$
D. $Z\ X\ Y$

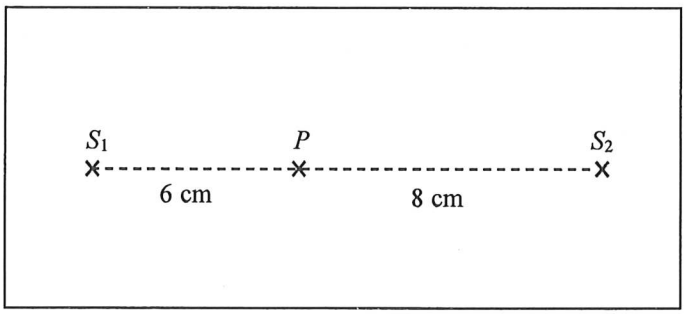
15. The graph shows the variation of the displacement of air particles from their equilibrium positions with distance for a sound wave at a certain instant. Displacement along the direction of wave propagation is taken to be positive.



Which statement concerning the wave at that instant is correct ?

A. An air particle at P is momentarily at rest.
B. A rarefaction occurs at Q.
C. A compression occurs at R.
D. An air particle at R is moving with the greatest speed.

16. In the ripple tank shown below, dippers S_1 and S_2 are vibrating in phase and generate water waves of wavelength 0.8 cm towards each other at the same speed. For a particle P at distances 6 cm and 8 cm from S_1 and S_2 respectively as shown, the amplitude of the waves reaching P from S_1 is 1 mm while that from S_2 is 2 mm.



What is the amplitude of oscillation of P ?

A. 0 mm
B. 1 mm
C. 2 mm
D. 3 mm

*17. The light from a sodium lamp consists of two wavelengths 589.00 nm and 589.59 nm. Find the angle between these two spectral lines in the second-order after the light passes through a diffraction grating of 600 lines per mm.

A. 0.058°
B. 0.041°
C. 0.022°
D. 0.021°

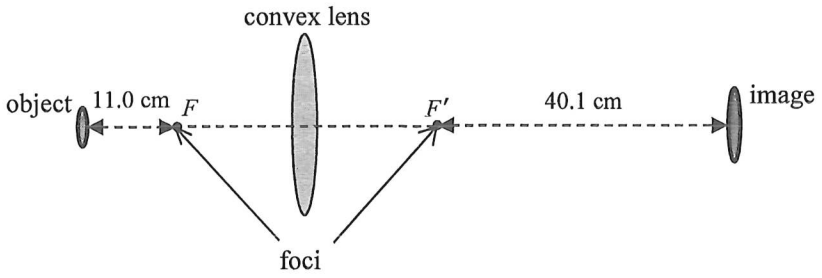
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18. In an experiment, monochromatic light is incident normally on a double slit and a diffraction grating placed in turn at the same position. The respective interference and diffraction patterns formed on the screen are observed. Which of the following statements about the patterns is/are correct ?

(1) The fringe separation of the interference pattern is wider.
(2) The fringes of the diffraction pattern are sharper.
(3) The width of the whole diffraction pattern is wider.

A. (1) only
B. (2) only
C. (1) and (3) only
D. (2) and (3) only

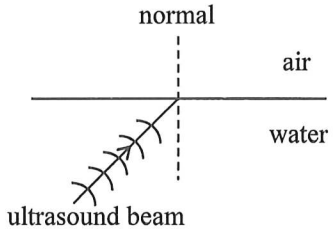
*19. An object is placed at a certain distance from a convex lens, the position of a screen is adjusted until a sharp image is formed.



Given that the distances of the object and the image to the respective foci F and F' of the convex lens are 11.0 cm and 40.1 cm as shown, the focal length of the lens is

A. 8.6 cm.
B. 17.3 cm.
C. 21.0 cm.
D. 25.9 cm.

20. A source in water emits a beam of ultrasound towards the water-air interface as shown.



Which of the following statements is **INCORRECT** ?

A. The frequency of the refracted beam is the same as that of the incident beam.
B. The speed of the refracted beam becomes smaller.
C. The refracted beam leaving the interface bends towards the normal.
D. If the angle of incidence is large enough, total internal reflection may occur.

21. Which of the following phenomena can be explained by the speed of waves being different in different media ?

(1) echoes
(2) rainbows
(3) mirages

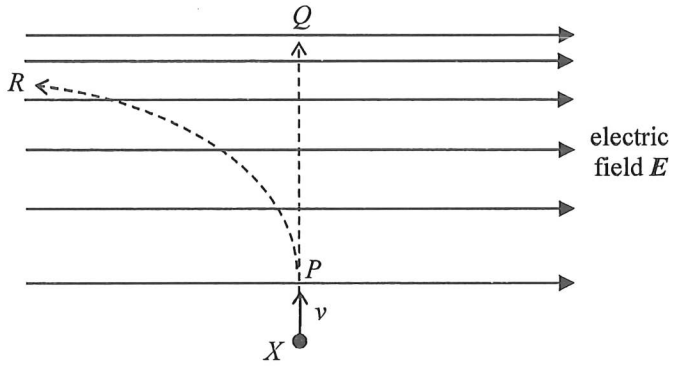
A. (1) and (2) only
B. (1) and (3) only
C. (2) and (3) only
D. (1), (2) and (3)

22. Three light conducting spheres are suspended by nylon threads. Any two of them are found to attract each other when they are brought close to each other. Which conclusion below is correct ?

A. All three spheres are charged.
B. Only one sphere is charged.
C. Only one sphere is uncharged and the other two carry like charges.
D. Only one sphere is uncharged and the other two carry unlike charges.

23. A negatively charged particle X enters an electric field with initial velocity v perpendicular to the field lines as shown. Neglect the effects of gravity.

Top view

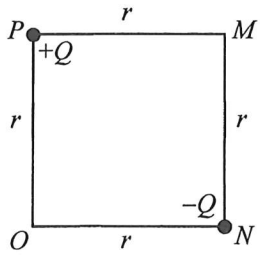


Particle X may move along

A. PQ with uniform speed.
B. PQ with increasing speed.
C. PR with decreasing speed.
D. PR with increasing speed.

Go on to the next page

*24.



Point charges $+Q$ and $-Q$ are fixed respectively at corners P and N of square $MNOP$ of side length r as shown above. What is the electric field at O ?

A. $\frac{\sqrt{2}Q}{4\pi\varepsilon_0 r^2}$ along the direction from P to N

B. $\frac{Q}{4\pi\varepsilon_0 r^2}$ along the direction from P to N

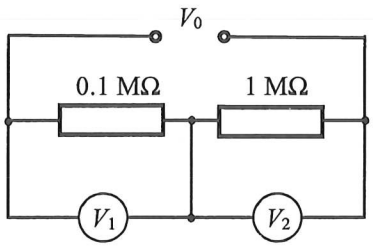
C. $\frac{\sqrt{2}Q}{4\pi\varepsilon_0 r^2}$ along the direction from N to P

D. $\frac{Q}{4\pi\varepsilon_0 r^2}$ along the direction from N to P

25. A student tests an electric circuit by connecting a filament light bulb to a dry cell using two connecting wires. The bulb does not light up. Which of the following is certainly **NOT** a possible explanation ?

A. The dry cell may be flat.
B. The circuit may be open due to a bad connection.
C. The dry cell may have its polarities connected the wrong way round.
D. The bulb may have blown.

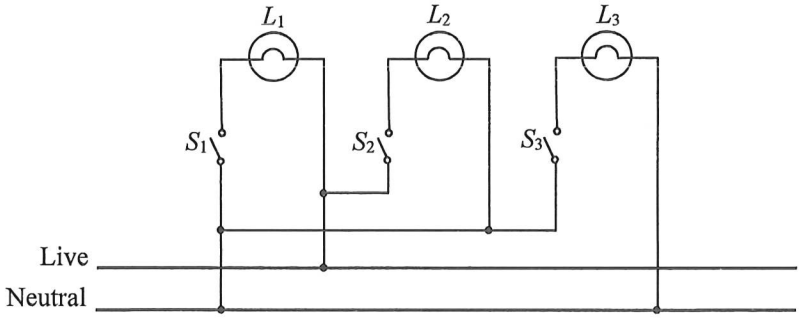
26. In the circuit below, a voltage V_0 is applied across resistors of 0.1 MΩ and 1 MΩ connected in series. Voltmeter V_1 and V_2 are connected respectively across the two resistors as shown. V_1 is ideal while V_2 has an internal resistance of 1 MΩ.



Estimate the ratio of the voltmeter readings $V_1 : V_2$.

A. 5 : 1
B. 1 : 5
C. 10 : 1
D. 1 : 10

27. The figure shows how lamps L_1, L_2 and L_3 are connected in the ring circuit of a house. There are some wrong connections in the circuit.

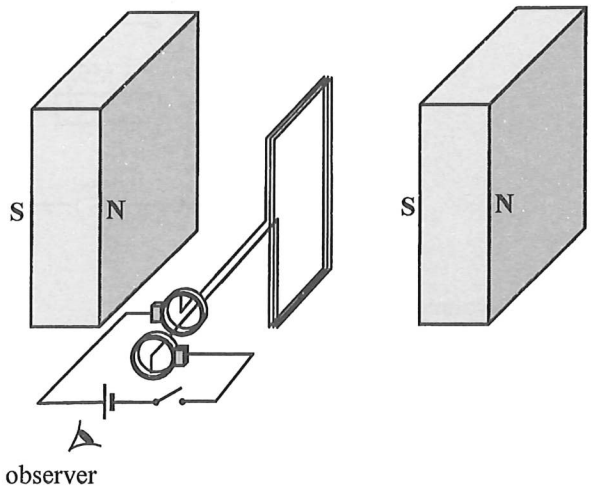


If switches S_2 and S_3 are closed while switch S_1 remains open, which of the lamps will light up ?

A. L_2 only
B. L_3 only
C. L_2 and L_3 only
D. none of them

Go on to the next page

28. The figure shows a rectangular coil connected in series with a dry cell and a switch through a pair of slip rings. The magnetic field between the two magnets is uniform and is perpendicular to the plane of the coil at the moment shown.



When the switch is closed, the coil will

A. remain at rest.
B. rotate in a clockwise direction continuously.
C. rotate in an anticlockwise direction continuously.
D. change the direction of rotation after turning through 180°.

*29. A student uses a search coil to measure the magnetic field of a permanent magnet. However, no reading is observed on the CRO connected to the search coil. Which of the following is the possible reason ?

A. The magnet is not strong enough.
B. The magnetic field produced by the magnet is constant.
C. The sensitivity of the CRO is too low.
D. The size of the search coil is not large enough to pick up sufficient magnetic flux.

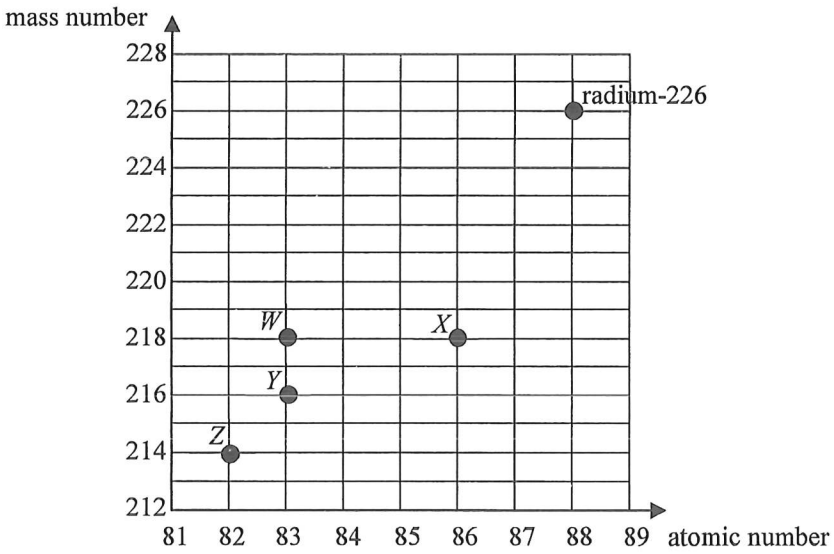
*30. An electric iron works at its rated power of 1100 W under a 50 Hz a.c. mains of root-mean-square voltage 220 V. What power will it deliver when working under a 100 Hz a.c. of root-mean-square voltage 110 V ?

A. 275 W
B. 778 W
C. 550 W
D. 1100 W

31. A radioactive source undergoes decay such that 300 nuclides have decayed in 1 minute. Its activity is

A. 0.2 Bq.
B. 5 Bq.
C. 300 Bq.
D. 18000 Bq.

32. Radium-226 undergoes a series of α and β decays before finally becomes a stable nuclide. Referring to the plot of mass number against atomic number below, which nuclides, W, X, Y and Z, **cannot** be possible members in the decay series of radium-226 ?



A. W and X
B. W and Y
C. Z and X
D. Z and Y

*33. In the following nuclear reaction, nuclide X and Y fuse to form nuclide Z under suitable conditions and the amount of energy released is 7.16 MeV.

$$X + Y \rightarrow Z$$

The total mass of X and Y is

A. 0.00385 u less than the mass of Z.
B. 0.00385 u more than the mass of Z.
C. 0.00769 u less than the mass of Z.
D. 0.00769 u more than the mass of Z.

END OF SECTION A

List of data, formulae and relationships

Data

molar gas constant	$R = 8.31$ J mol^{-1} K^{-1}
Avogadro constant	$N_A = 6.02 \times 10^{23}$ mol^{-1}
acceleration due to gravity	$g = 9.81$ m s^{-2} (close to the Earth)
universal gravitational constant	$G = 6.67 \times 10^{-11}$ N m^2 kg^{-2}
speed of light in vacuum	$c = 3.00 \times 10^8$ m s^{-1}
charge of electron	$q_e = 1.60 \times 10^{-19}$ C
electron rest mass	$m_e = 9.11 \times 10^{-31}$ kg
permittivity of free space	$\varepsilon_0 = 8.85 \times 10^{-12}$ C^2 N^{-1} m^{-2}
permeability of free space	$\mu_0 = 4\pi \times 10^{-7}$ H m^{-1}
atomic mass unit	u = 1.661×10^{-27} kg (1 u is equivalent to 931 MeV)
astronomical unit	AU = 1.50×10^{11} m
light year	ly = 9.46×10^{15} m
parsec	pc = 3.09×10^{16} m = 3.26 ly = 206265 AU
Stefan constant	$\sigma = 5.67 \times 10^{-8}$ W m^{-2} K^{-4}
Planck constant	$h = 6.63 \times 10^{-34}$ J s

Rectilinear motion

For uniformly accelerated motion :

$$v = u + at$$
$$s = ut + \frac{1}{2}at^2$$
$$v^2 = u^2 + 2as$$

Mathematics

Equation of a straight line	$y = mx + c$
Arc length	$= r\theta$
Surface area of cylinder	$= 2\pi rh + 2\pi r^2$
Volume of cylinder	$= \pi r^2 h$
Surface area of sphere	$= 4\pi r^2$
Volume of sphere	$= \frac{4}{3}\pi r^3$

For small angles, $\sin\theta \approx \tan\theta \approx \theta$ (in radians)

Astronomy and Space Science	
$U = -\frac{GMm}{r}$	gravitational potential energy
$P = \sigma AT^4$	Stefan's law
$\left\|\frac{\Delta f}{f_0}\right\| \approx \frac{v}{c} \approx \left\|\frac{\Delta\lambda}{\lambda_0}\right\|$	Doppler effect

Energy and Use of Energy	
$E = \frac{\Phi}{A}$	illuminance
$\frac{Q}{t} = \kappa\frac{A(T_H - T_C)}{d}$	rate of energy transfer by conduction
$U = \frac{\kappa}{d}$	thermal transmittance U-value
$P = \frac{1}{2}\rho A v^3$	maximum power by wind turbine

Atomic World	
$\frac{1}{2}m_e v_{max}{}^2 = hf - \phi$	Einstein's photoelectric equation
$E_n = -\frac{1}{n^2}\left\{\frac{m_e q_e^4}{8h^2\varepsilon_0^2}\right\} = -\frac{13.6}{n^2}$ eV	energy level equation for hydrogen atom
$\lambda = \frac{h}{p} = \frac{h}{mv}$	de Broglie formula
$\theta \approx \frac{1.22\lambda}{d}$	Rayleigh criterion (resolving power)

Medical Physics	
$\theta \approx \frac{1.22\lambda}{d}$	Rayleigh criterion (resolving power)
power $= \frac{1}{f}$	power of a lens
$L = 10\log\frac{I}{I_0}$	intensity level (dB)
$Z = \rho c$	acoustic impedance
$\alpha = \frac{I_r}{I_0} = \frac{(Z_2 - Z_1)^2}{(Z_2 + Z_1)^2}$	intensity reflection coefficient
$I = I_0 e^{-\mu x}$	transmitted intensity through a medium

A1.	$E = mc\,\Delta T$	energy transfer during heating and cooling
A2.	$E = l\,\Delta m$	energy transfer during change of state
A3.	$pV = nRT$	equation of state for an ideal gas
A4.	$pV = \frac{1}{3}Nm\overline{c^2}$	kinetic theory equation
A5.	$E_K = \frac{3RT}{2N_A}$	molecular kinetic energy

B1.	$F = m\frac{\Delta v}{\Delta t} = \frac{\Delta p}{\Delta t}$	force
B2.	moment $= F \times d$	moment of a force
B3.	$E_P = mgh$	gravitational potential energy
B4.	$E_K = \frac{1}{2}mv^2$	kinetic energy
B5.	$P = Fv$	mechanical power
B6.	$a = \frac{v^2}{r} = \omega^2 r$	centripetal acceleration
B7.	$F = \frac{Gm_1m_2}{r^2}$	Newton's law of gravitation

C1.	$\Delta y = \frac{\lambda D}{a}$	fringe separation in double-slit interference
C2.	$d\sin\theta = n\lambda$	diffraction grating equation
C3.	$\frac{1}{u} + \frac{1}{v} = \frac{1}{f}$	equation for a single lens

D1.	$F = \frac{Q_1Q_2}{4\pi\varepsilon_0 r^2}$	Coulomb's law
D2.	$E = \frac{Q}{4\pi\varepsilon_0 r^2}$	electric field strength due to a point charge
D3.	$E = \frac{V}{d}$	electric field between parallel plates (numerically)
D4.	$R = \frac{\rho l}{A}$	resistance and resistivity
D5.	$R = R_1 + R_2$	resistors in series
D6.	$\frac{1}{R} = \frac{1}{R_1} + \frac{1}{R_2}$	resistors in parallel
D7.	$P = IV = I^2R$	power in a circuit
D8.	$F = BQv\sin\theta$	force on a moving charge in a magnetic field
D9.	$F = BIl\sin\theta$	force on a current-carrying conductor in a magnetic field
D10.	$B = \frac{\mu_0 I}{2\pi r}$	magnetic field due to a long straight wire
D11.	$B = \frac{\mu_0 NI}{l}$	magnetic field inside a long solenoid
D12.	$\varepsilon = N\frac{\Delta\Phi}{\Delta t}$	induced e.m.f.
D13.	$\frac{V_s}{V_p} \approx \frac{N_s}{N_p}$	ratio of secondary voltage to primary voltage in a transformer

E1.	$N = N_0e^{-kt}$	law of radioactive decay
E2.	$t_{\frac{1}{2}} = \frac{\ln 2}{k}$	half-life and decay constant
E3.	$A = kN$	activity and the number of undecayed nuclei
E4.	$\Delta E = \Delta mc^2$	mass-energy relationship